

Boselaphus tragocamelus

Nilgai



Length 6–7 ft (1.8–2.1 m)
Tail 18–21 in (45–53 cm)
Weight Up to 660 lb (300 kg)
Location S. Asia
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



Also called bluebuck or blue bull, the nilgai is a small-headed bovid with longer front than rear legs, and, in the male, stout, tapering horns 8 in (20 cm) long. The male's coat is gray or bluish gray;



the female's is tawny. The nilgai prefers open woods to thick forest, is very wary, with sharp senses, and flees rapidly from predators such as tigers. It grazes and browses on a wide variety of grasses, leaves, and fruit, from early to midmorning and in the early evening. Males compete for territories—and thus access to groups of 2–10 females—by kneeling in front of each other and lunging with their horns. Breeding occurs during much of the year but most calves, either one or 2, are born in June–October, after a gestation of 243–247 days.

Tetracerus quadricornus

Chousingha



Length 32–39 in (80–100 cm)
Tail 4¾ in (12 cm)
Weight 37–46 lb (17–21 kg)
Location S. Asia
Social unit Individual
Status Vulnerable



Also called the four-horned antelope, the male chousingha has 2 pairs of horns—a feature unique among bovids. The front pair, at only 1¼–1½ in (3–4 cm) long, are half the length of the rear pair. The habits of this shy, fast-moving

antelope are little known. It grazes on grasses, sedges, and other plants, usually near water in wooded hills, and communicates by a low whistle for identification or barks for alarm. The brownish coat has a dark stripe on the front of each leg, and a black muzzle and outer ear surfaces.



Bubalus depressicornis

Anoa



Length 3¾–4¼ ft (1.2–1.3 m)
Tail 7–12 in (18–31 cm)
Weight Up to 660 lb (300 kg)
Location Sulawesi
Social unit Individual
Status Endangered



Smallest of the wild cattle species, the anoa has a large body, short legs, and a small head. Both males and females have horns. Usually brown or black in color, they may have white markings on the

forelegs, face, and throat. Usually solitary and nocturnal, they feed mainly on plants, supplemented by fruits from trees, such as the fig. Females produce a single calf after a 9–10 month gestation period. There are 4 genetically distinct populations, but whether they are sufficiently different to be considered species in their own right is still under review.



Bubalus arnee

Asian wild buffalo



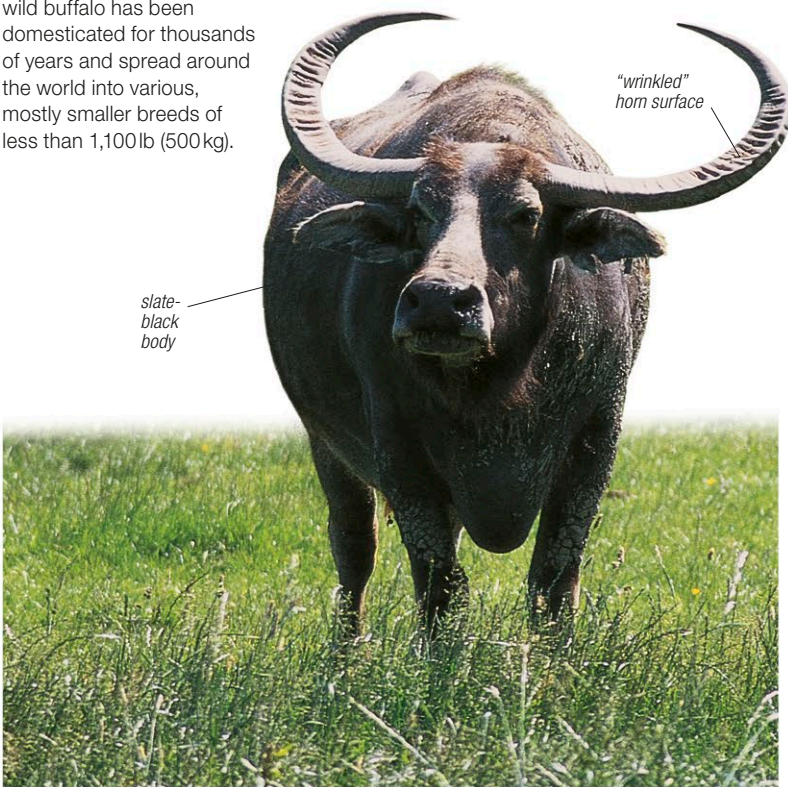
Length 7¾–9¾ ft (2.4–3 m)
Tail 23½–39 in (60–100 cm)
Weight Up to 1.3 tons (1.2 tonnes)
Location S. Asia
Social unit Group
Status Endangered



At more than 1 ton in weight, the Asian wild buffalo—or arni as it is also known—is a massive, powerful animal, with the widest horn span of any bovid—more than 6½ ft (2 m). Its large, splayed feet and flexible fetlock joints are suited to the muddy, marshy ground on which this water buffalo grazes. They mainly eat lush grasses and sedges but will supplement this if necessary with fruits, forbs, and bark. Depending on the temperature, they may be active during the day or the night, feeding for periods and then resting to ruminate their meal. A stable clan of females with young is led by a dominant matriarch and a mature bull. Females give birth only every other year because the gestation period is 300 to 400 days, which is the longest of any bovid species. Males leave their natal herd at about 3 years

of age and form bachelor groups of about 10. Young males spar to assert dominance but avoid serious fighting, and then mix with females at mating time. The Asian wild buffalo has been domesticated for thousands of years and spread around the world into various, mostly smaller breeds of less than 1,100 lb (500 kg).

The remaining wild populations are scattered and scant, restricted mainly to India, Nepal, and perhaps Thailand.



WALLOWING



During the midday heat, Asian wild buffaloes wallow in water or muddy pools, sometimes almost completely submerged, with only their nostrils showing. In addition to keeping them cool, wallowing helps to remove skin parasites, biting flies, and other pests that infest tropical swamps.

BIG-HORNED BOVID

The large horns, which project from the sides of the head, extend sideways before curving upward and inward. The largest horns are seen in water buffalo from India and Nepal.